

TALK-ALONG FIRSTS

BOOK 1

Up! Go! More!

22 first words to say, sign and act out



Play Before Pixels



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Up! Go! More!

22 first words to say, sign and act out

Talk-Along Firsts, Book 1 · Talk-along paperback edition

Play Before Pixels

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This book is for reading together. It shares everyday play and talk ideas for
families. It is not medical or developmental advice; for questions about your
child, talk with your child's doctor.

Paper pages: read together and keep away from mouths.

First edition · Version 1.0 · September 2026

playbeforepixels.com

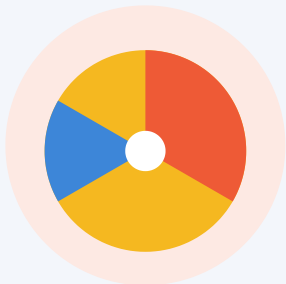
A note for grown-ups

This book is small on purpose. One word, one picture and one thing to copy on each page, so there is room for the most important part: the two of you, taking turns.

You don't need to read every tip, finish the book or get anything right. Go slow. Wait. Copy your child's sounds and moves, and let them copy yours. That back-and-forth is the whole idea.

Thank you for reading with your little one.

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How to read this book together



Say it

a sound to copy



Sign it

a simple hand sign



Act it

a move to do together

1

Go slow. One word per page. Say it, point to the picture, then pause.

2

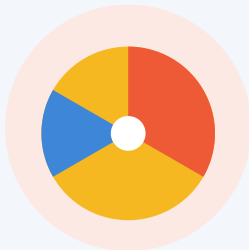
Wait for a turn. Count to five in your head. A look, a point, a sign, a sound or a tap on a talking device is your child's turn.

3

Copy each other. Try the say it, sign it or act it idea. Then copy whatever your child does back.

4

Pick any tip, skip any tip. It's their book: skip ahead, go back, or stay on one page.



Every child talks on their own timeline. If you have questions about your child's speech or development, your child's doctor is a good place to start. Talk, sing and read in the language you know best. Every language counts.

hi



ACT IT

Wave hello!

GROWN-UP TIP **Take turns.** Say “hi!” and count to five in your head. A look, wave or sound back counts as a turn.

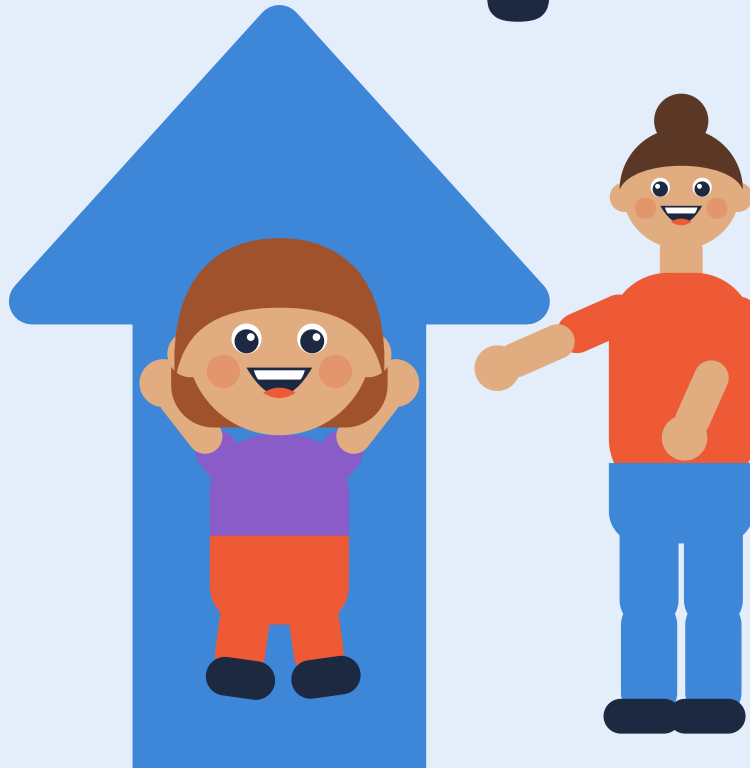
peekaboo



Hide your eyes... boo!

GROWN-UP TIP Build the pause. Hide, wait a beat, then pop out. In time, your child may fill that pause with a squeal or a sound.

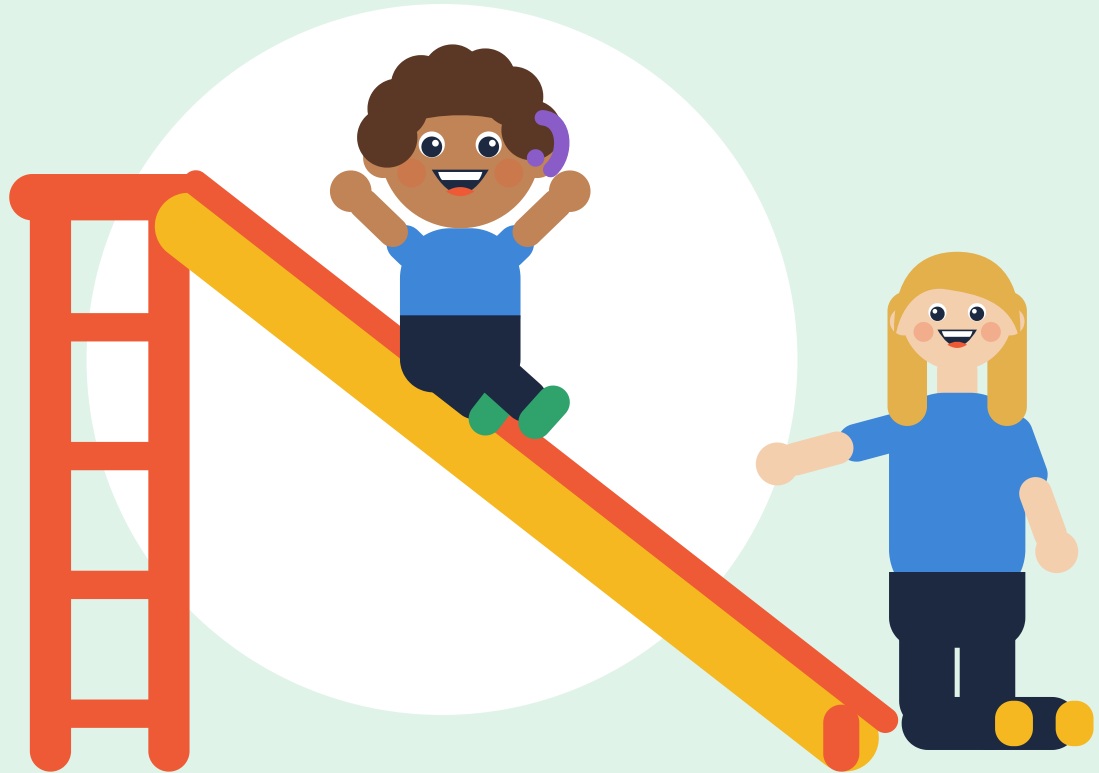
up



Reach your arms up high

GROWN-UP TIP Wait for it. Hold your arms out, then pause. When they reach up, say “up!” as you lift.

down



Let your voice slide: dooown!

GROWN-UP TIP Say it **big**. Crouch low and stretch the word out. Slow, playful words are easier to copy.

go



Ready, set... go!

GROWN-UP TIP Leave a gap. Say "Ready, set..." then stop and wait. Let your child fill in "go!" Any sound counts.

stop



Hold up a flat hand

GROWN-UP TIP Make it a game. Zoom a toy car and freeze on “stop!” Then let your child be the one who says it.

ball



SAY IT

Bounce, bounce, boing!

GROWN-UP TIP Add one word. If your child says “ball,” you say “big ball” or “roll ball.” Just one step ahead.

in



In it goes... plop!

GROWN-UP TIP Repeat it. Drop blocks in one at a time: “in... in... in!” Words heard again and again are easier to try.

open



Close your hands, then pop them open

GROWN-UP TIP **Wait for a signal.** Hold the box shut and wait. A look, a tap or a sound tells you what they want.

WOW



SAY IT

Make a round mouth: woow!

GROWN-UP TIP Say what you see. Look where your child looks and name it: "Wow! Big sun!" Short and bright beats long and busy.

uh-oh

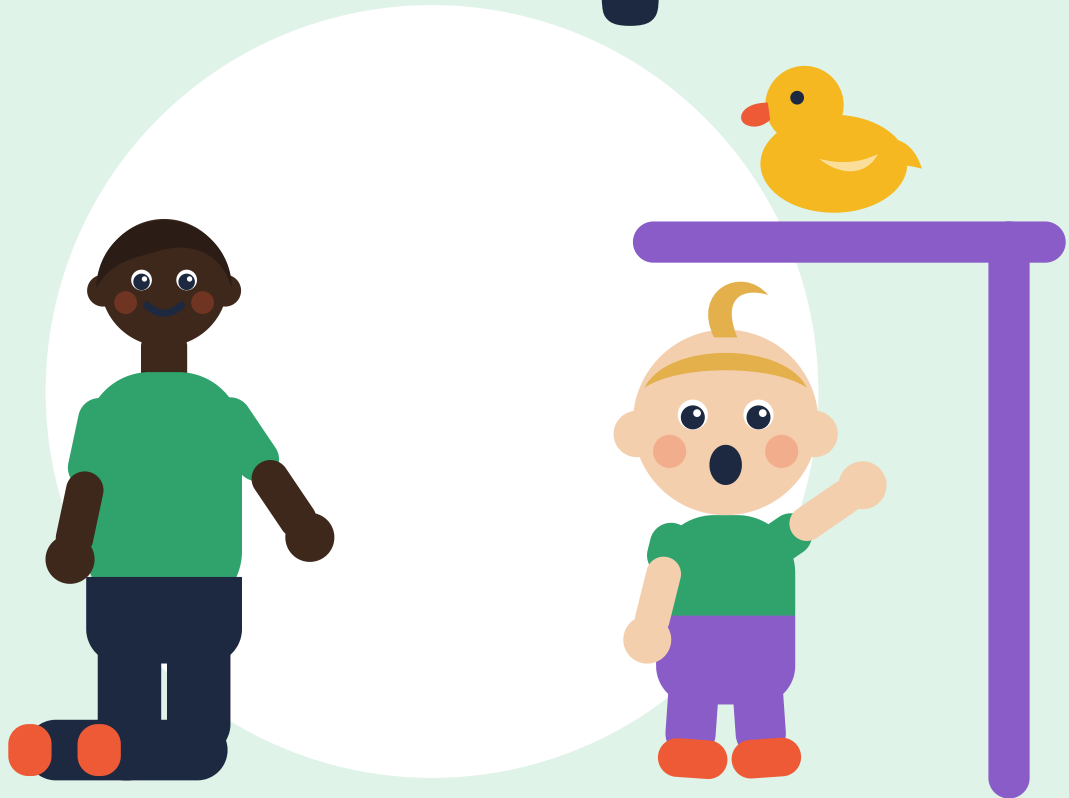


ACT IT

Hands on cheeks: uh-oh!

GROWN-UP TIP **Name the moment.** Little tumbles are talk moments. Say “uh-oh!” with a big face, then wait.

help



SIGN IT

Thumbs-up on open palm, lift up

GROWN-UP TIP Set up a reason to ask. Put a favorite toy just out of reach and wait. A reach, point or sound is asking.

clap



Clap, clap, clap!

GROWN-UP TIP **Copy them.** Clap back the way your child claps: fast, slow, loud or soft. Copying says “I’m listening.”

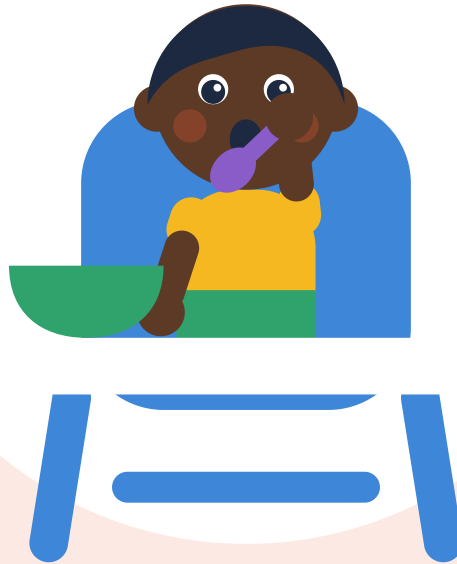
shoe



Stomp, stomp your feet

GROWN-UP TIP Follow their lead. Grabbed a shoe? Talk about the shoe: “Your shoe. Big shoe. Shoe on!”

eat

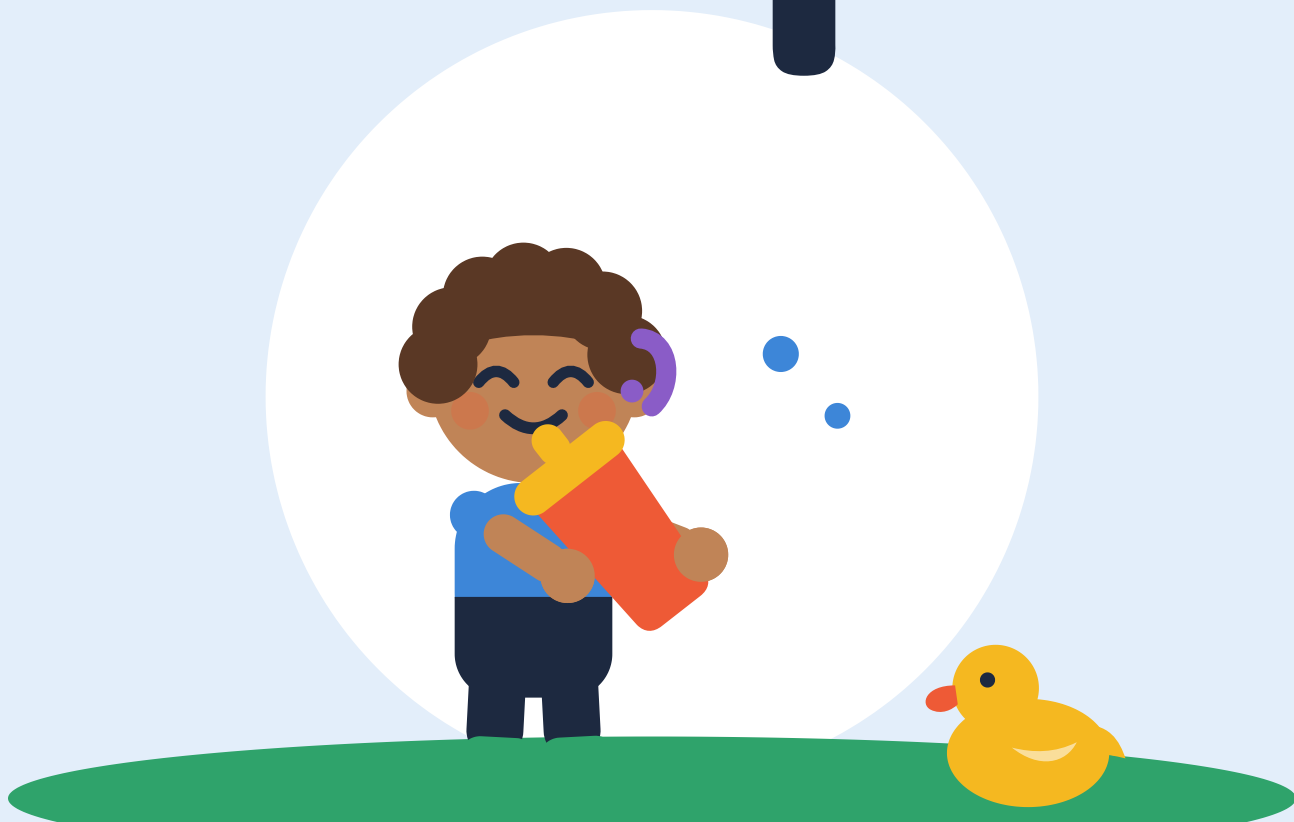


SIGN IT

Fingertips to your lips

GROWN-UP TIP **Talk about now.** Name what is happening at the table as it happens: “Eat. You eat. Yum!”

cup



SAY IT

Sip, sip... ahh!

GROWN-UP TIP **Keep it short.** Two or three words at a time: “Cup. Your cup. Sip!”
Short phrases are easy to copy.

more



SIGN IT

Tap your fingertips together

GROWN-UP TIP **Pause the fun.** Stop the bubbles, ask “more?” and wait. A sign, a look or a sound means go again.

all done

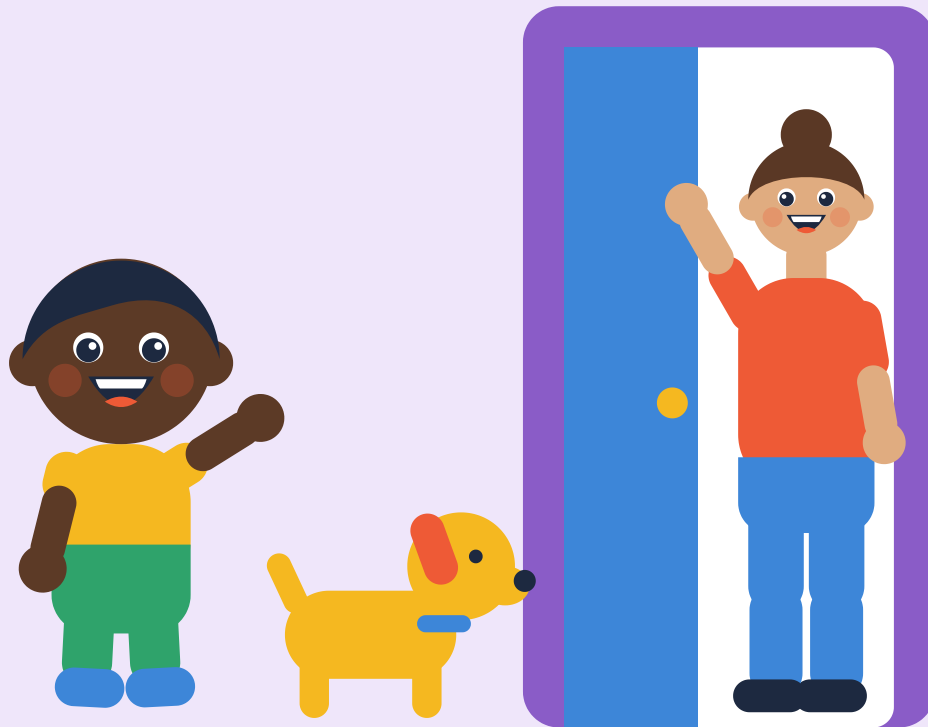


SIGN IT

Open hands up, twist back and forth

GROWN-UP TIP Offer a choice. “More, or all done?” Hold up a hand for each. A point is a real answer.

bye-bye



Blow a kiss: mwah!

GROWN-UP TIP Make it a routine. Same wave, same words, every time. Words that repeat are the easiest to pick up.

book



SIGN IT

Press palms together, then open

GROWN-UP TIP Let them turn. Let your child turn the pages and choose where to stop. Name whatever they point at.

hug



Hug yourself tight

GROWN-UP TIP **Sing it.** Put “hug” in any tune you know and squeeze on the last one. Not a hugger? A high five works too.

night-night



SAY IT

Whisper: shhh... zzz

GROWN-UP TIP Wind down. Say “night-night” to everything: the duck, the moon, even the tablet. A calm goodnight game.

Keep the words going

Use these words again and again, in the same moments each day.

HELLOS & GOODBYES

hi

peekaboo

bye-bye

hug

MEALTIME

eat

cup

more

all done

uh-oh

PLAYTIME

ball

go

stop

up

down

in

open

clap

wow

GETTING DRESSED

shoe

help

BEDTIME

book

night-night

No screen needed. Just the two of you, and a little time to wait.

Our word list

Just for fun. Tick a word the first time your child says, signs or taps it, in any language, and jot the date. Every child has their own timeline, so there is no right time for any box.

☐ hi _____

☐ up _____

☐ go _____

☐ ball _____

☐ open _____

☐ uh-oh _____

☐ clap _____

☐ eat _____

☐ more _____

☐ bye-bye _____

☐ hug _____

☐ peekaboo _____

☐ down _____

☐ stop _____

☐ in _____

☐ wow _____

☐ help _____

☐ shoe _____

☐ cup _____

☐ all done _____

☐ book _____

☐ night-night _____

Add your own words

Your child's first words may be different from the ones in this book. Grown-ups, add the words that matter in your home: names, pets, a favorite food, words in your home language.

Grown-up: add a photo or sketch

WORD: _____

Grown-up: add a photo or sketch

WORD: _____

Grown-up: add a photo or sketch

WORD: _____

Grown-up: add a photo or sketch

WORD: _____

FREE FOR GROWN-UPS

Keep the talk going after the book closes

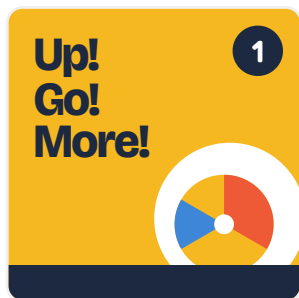


playbeforepixels.com/bonus/board-up-go-more

Scan for printable word cards and a one-page “say it, sign it, act it” sheet for the fridge. We only ask for your child’s birth month and year, never their name.

THE TALK-ALONG FIRSTS SERIES

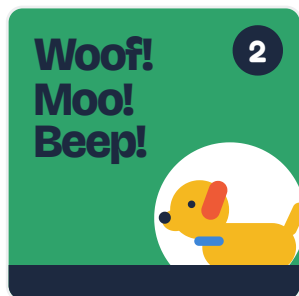
Collect all three



Book 1: Up! Go! More!

First words

YOU ARE HOLDING IT



Book 2: Woof! Moo! Beep!

Sounds & animals

COMING SOON



Book 3: Yum! Splash! Yawn!

Routines & feelings

COMING SOON

Same size, same style, same grown-up tips, made to sit together on the shelf.



The end.

Night-night, book. Read it again tomorrow?